

Northgate University

Remote Working Policy

An ISO/IEC 27001:2013 aligned document · Internal Use Only

Document Reference	NGU-POL-6.2
Version	1.0
Classification	Internal Use Only
Issue Date	01 June 2026
Policy Owner	Chief Information Security Officer
Approved By	Information Governance Board
Next Review Date	01 June 2027
Aligned Standard	ISO/IEC 27001:2013 — Annex A.6.2

1. Purpose

This policy sets out how Northgate University ("the University") enables secure remote and home working, ensuring that University information remains protected when accessed or used away from University premises, in line with ISO/IEC 27001:2013 Annex A.6.2.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all staff, students, contractors, and third parties who access University information or systems from any location other than University premises, using University-provided or personal devices. It covers home working, mobile working, and the use of mobile devices.

3. General Principles

- Remote working is permitted where it can be carried out securely and in line with this policy.
- Information must be given the same protection when accessed remotely as it receives on University premises.
- An asset's information classification and handling requirements continue to apply wherever it is accessed.
- Where remote working introduces additional risk, additional controls may be required.

4. Eligibility and Authorisation

Regular remote or home working is arranged with the individual's line manager. Work involving Confidential information, or access to particularly sensitive systems, may be subject to additional controls or restrictions determined by the relevant Information Asset Owner.

5. Device Security

Devices used for University work must meet the following minimum requirements (ISO/IEC 27001:2013 A.6.2.1):

Requirement	Detail
Encryption	Full-disk encryption enabled on any device used for University work.
Authentication	Device protected by a password, PIN, or biometric; MFA used for University accounts.
Updates	Operating system and applications kept up to date with security patches.
Endpoint protection	Anti-malware protection installed and active on laptops and desktops.
Screen lock	Automatic screen lock after a short period of inactivity.
Local storage	Confidential information not stored locally on personal devices without approval.

- University-provided devices are centrally managed, encrypted, patched, and protected with endpoint security, and must not be altered to bypass these controls.
- Personal devices (BYOD) may be used only where permitted; they must meet the minimum requirements above, and Confidential information must not be stored locally on them without approval.

6. Network and Connection Security

- Multi-factor authentication is mandatory for all remote access to University systems (see Access Control Policy, NGU-POL-9.1).
- Remote connections to University systems must use the approved secure connection method, such as the University VPN, where required.
- Avoid using untrusted or public Wi-Fi for University work unless the connection is protected; never disable security controls in order to connect.

7. Handling University Information Off-Site

- University information must be handled in line with its classification at all times (see Information Classification Policy, NGU-POL-8.2).
- Confidential information must be protected in transit and at rest and must not be saved to unapproved personal or cloud storage services.
- Avoid printing University information remotely; where unavoidable, store and dispose of it securely.

8. Physical Security When Working Remotely

- Position screens so that information cannot be overlooked, particularly in public spaces.
- Lock or log off devices whenever they are left unattended.
- Store devices and any physical information securely; do not leave them unattended in vehicles or public places (A.11.2.6).

9. Acceptable Use

University information and systems accessed remotely must be used only for legitimate University purposes. Family members and others must not be permitted to access University devices, information, or accounts (A.8.1.3).

10. Incident Reporting

Lost or stolen devices, and any suspected compromise of University information or accounts, must be reported immediately through the University's incident channel so that access can be protected (see Information Security Incident Management Policy, NGU-POL-16.1).

11. Return of Assets

On leaving the University or ending an engagement, all University equipment and information held remotely must be returned or securely destroyed (A.8.1.4).

12. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Chief Information Security Officer (CISO).** Owns this policy and defines remote working security standards.
- **Line Managers.** Authorise remote working and ensure their staff understand and follow this policy.
- **IT Service.** Provides and manages secure remote access, managed devices, and supporting controls.
- **Information Asset Owners (IAOs).** Determine any additional controls for remote access to sensitive assets.
- **All users.** Comply with this policy and protect University information and devices when working remotely.

13. Compliance and Enforcement

Compliance with this policy is mandatory. Working remotely in a way that places University information at risk may result in withdrawal of remote access and disciplinary action, and, for third parties, may constitute a breach of contract.

14. Related Policies and Standards

- Information Security Policy (NGU-POL-5.1)
- Access Control Policy (NGU-POL-9.1)
- Information Classification Policy (NGU-POL-8.2)
- Information Security Incident Management Policy (NGU-POL-16.1)
- ISO/IEC 27001:2013 — Annex A.6.2 (A.6.2.1, A.6.2.2); A.11.2.6
- UK GDPR and Data Protection Act 2018

15. Document Version History

Version	Date	Author	Summary of Change
1.0	01 June 2026	Chief Information Security Officer	Initial issue. Establishes secure remote and mobile working requirements.